PROJECT CHARTER & BASELINE BASELINE

BUS 141 CAPSTONE SPECIFICATION

The Treat Truck: Project Charter & Governance

Project Lead: Tanzaneya Taylor **Institution:** Univ. of Maine at Presque Isle **Target Launch:** Greater Atlanta / Douglasville, GA

Capital Baseline: $106,550

SCHEDULE WINDOW	CAPITAL APPROVED	TARGET MARGIN	BREAK-EVEN TICKET
6–9 Mos	**$106,550**	**73.2%**	**47 Cust/Day**
Baseline Schedule Gate	Includes $5k Reserve	Direct COGS ≤ 30%	$10 Avg Order Volume

Project Mission

To satisfy the "little something sweet" craving by delivering creative, handmade confectionery desserts through an accessible, consistent, and premium mobile experience across high-traffic metro hubs and private events.

Project Vision

Establish the signature *Lilac Truck* as an unmistakable community staple, cultivating lasting customer loyalty through artisanal product standards and dependable route and event schedules.

PROJECT GOALS & MEASURABLE OBJECTIVES

- Form Georgia LLC and secure GDPH mobile health permit and Douglasville food truck approvals.
- Source, retrofit, and wrap the commercial mobile truck with custom lilac branding within 5 months.
- Engineer 8 launch desserts holding direct ingredient and packaging costs under 30% of gross margin.
- Maintain schedule control to achieve grand opening in Month 8 within the $106,550 capital baseline.

STAKEHOLDER AUTHORITY & DECISION MATRIX

Stakeholder Role	Primary Governance Responsibilities	Decision-Making Level
Project Owner / Sponsor Jalen Carter	Overall strategic vision, budget allocation authorization, baseline change approvals, and release of contingency reserves.	**Final Approval Authority** (Scope, baseline budget ≥ $250, schedule)
Project Manager Aaliyah Bennet	Daily task coordination, critical path monitoring, risk register management, vendor tracking, and status communication.	**Operational Authority** (Adjustments < $250, schedule shifts < 3 days)
Food Prep & Menu Lead Launch Operations Staff	Recipe standardization, direct cost validation, kitchen inventory setup, portion tool enforcement, and staff food safety training.	**Consultative Authority** (Ingredient specs, batching, prep SOPs)
Truck & Technical Lead Commercial Build Vendor	Interior commercial equipment install, mechanical retrofit, water and electrical load tests, generator integration, and exterior wrap.	**Execution Authority** (Physical fabrication and equipment testing)
Regulatory Authorities Douglasville / GDPH	Mobile unit plan review, physical health inspection, base of operations commissary approval, and business licensing.	**Mandatory External Authority** (Non-negotiable statutory compliance)

PROJECT SCOPE BOUNDARIES

✓ In-Scope Deliverables

- Formal GA LLC filing, business licensing, and GDPH mobile health permit acquisition.
- Sourcing, purchasing, mechanical customization, and exterior lilac vehicle wrapping.
- Installation and 48-hour stress testing of commercial refrigeration and kitchen equipment.
- 8-item dessert menu formulation, recipe cards, and unit COGS cost engineering.
- Operations SOP documentation (prep, sanitation, cash handling, and Square POS).
- Staff recruitment, food safety training, soft-launch simulation, and grand opening.

✕ Out-of-Scope Activities

- Routine post-launch daily truck operations and long-term payroll management.
- Ongoing marketing campaigns extending beyond the initial 60-day launch window.
- Acquiring additional food trucks, franchise expansion, or regional scaling.
- Leasing or building out a permanent brick-and-mortar dessert parlor storefront.
- Major menu expansions beyond the validated launch items prior to Month 12.
- Long-term corporate capital restructuring after formal project closeout.

PROJECT MILESTONE & SCHEDULE BASELINE (MONTHS 1–9)

The execution lifecycle spans 8 active months to the grand opening, with Month 9 allocated for financial reconciliation and closeout evaluation.

Milestone ID & Name	Timing	Major Phase Deliverables	Predecessors & Dependencies
M1: Planning Baseline	Month 1	Approved Project Charter, Scope Baseline, WBS, and GA LLC registration filing.	Project Sponsor Charter Authorization
M2: Permitting & Base	Month 2	Douglasville mobile permit filing, GDPH plan review, commissary kitchen agreement.	Approved Planning Baseline & LLC Filing
M3: Truck Acquisition	Month 5	Sourced vehicle, mechanical overhaul, commercial equipment install, and lilac wrap.	Capital Release & GDPH Equipment Specs
M4: Menu Cost Baseline	Month 4	8 standardized recipe cards, portion control tools, supplier unit cost validation.	Vendor Price Validation (Restaurant Depot)
M5: Procurement Setup	Month 4	Commercial wholesale accounts established; initial custom packaging inventory received.	Finalized Menu Specifications
M6: Staffing & Training	Month 5	Service staff recruited, food safety protocol training, Square POS simulation.	Operational SOP Documentation
M7: Marketing Deployed	Month 6	Social media launch schedule, local Douglasville signage, community event route booking.	Brand Assets & Lilac Truck Visuals
M8: Operational Readiness	Month 7	48-hour equipment stress test, soft-launch service run (<3 min ticket test), readiness sign-off.	M3 (Truck) + M4 (Menu) + M6 (Staff)
M9: Official Grand Launch	Month 8	Grand Opening event execution; transition to routine hybrid street and market service.	M8 Readiness Sign-off & City Clearances
M10: Project Closeout	Month 9	Final budget variance audit, lessons learned log, stakeholder sign-off, contract archive.	M9 Operational Launch Completion

Schedule Critical Path: M1 (Planning) → M2 (Permit Plans) → M3 (Truck Build & Utility Stress Testing) → M8 (Soft-Launch Simulation) → M9 (Grand Opening). Equipment fabrication lead times represent the primary constraint.

WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE (WBS) ARCHITECTURE

The project scope is deconstructed into 7 core level-1 work packages, defining discrete deliverables and accountability lines across each stage of launch.

1.0 Project Planning & Business Setup

Phase 1

- **1.1** Scope Statement & Requirements Definition
- **1.2** Comprehensive Business Plan & Model
- **1.3** Capital Budget & Cost Baseline ($106,550)
- **1.4** GA LLC Registration & Licensing Framework

2.0 Truck & Equipment Customization

Phase 2

- **2.1** Vehicle Sourcing & Procurement ($60,000)
- **2.2** Commercial Floor Plan & Ventilation Layout
- **2.3** Exterior Customization (Signature Lilac Wrap)
- **2.4** Commercial Equipment & Generator Install ($18.5k)
- **2.5** Water, Waste, & Electrical 48-Hour Functional Stress Test
- **2.6** Douglasville & GDPH Physical Health Inspections

3.0 Menu Engineering & Cost Modeling

Phase 3

- **3.1** Launch Dessert Categories Selection
- **3.2** Recipe Formulation & Batching Procedures
- **3.3** Ingredient Specification & Sourcing (Wholesale)
- **3.4** Sensory Quality Testing & Feedback Revision
- **3.5** Portion Control Standards & Serving Ware Rules
- **3.6** Unit Cost Modeling (Enforcing ≤30% Direct COGS)
- **3.7** Finalized Launch Menu Card & Pricing

4.0 Operations Architecture & Staffing

Phase 4

- **4.1** Standard Operating Procedures (Prep, Sanitization)
- **4.2** Staffing Model & Role Responsibility Matrix
- **4.3** Service Staff Recruitment & Interviewing
- **4.4** Training Program (POS, Food Safety, Portioning)
- **4.5** Base of Operations / Commissary Workflow Setup

5.0 Marketing, Brand & Promotion

Phase 5

- **5.1** Lilac Visual Identity, Logo, & Digital Assets
- **5.2** Social Media Channel Deployment & Content Calendar
- **5.3** Local Community Outreach & Route Permitting
- **5.4** Grand Opening Promotional Campaign Strategy

6.0 Operational Testing & Readiness

Phase 6

- **6.1** Live Kitchen Prep & Equipment Stress Testing
- **6.2** Square POS Configuration & Payment Flow Testing
- **6.3** Soft-Launch Simulation (Benchmarking <3 Min Ticket)
- **6.4** Final Operational Readiness Audit & Sign-off
- **6.5** Official Grand Opening Event Execution

7.0 Project Closeout & Operational Transition

Phase 7 • Closeout

7.1 Deliverable Audit: Verification of vehicle, menu cards, permits, and financial baseline integrity.

7.2 Post-Project Evaluation: Triple-constraint performance audit and Lessons Learned compilation.

7.3 Administrative Archival: Supplier contracts, financial books, and transition to routine business ops.

CAPITAL COST BASELINE ($106,550 APPROVED TOTAL)

Budget Line Item Category	Allocated
Used Food Truck Vehicle Sourcing	**$60,000**
Commercial Kitchen Equipment & Install	**$18,500**
Lilac Exterior Branding & Interior Outfitting	**$10,000**
Unallocated Contingency Reserve	**$5,000**
Initial Food Wholesale Inventory (Restaurant Depot)	$4,000

Budget Line Item Category	Allocated
Commissary Kitchen Security Deposit & Month 1	$2,500
Launch Marketing & Brand Promotional Campaign	$2,500
POS Hardware & Digital Technology Setup	$2,000
Custom Branded Packaging & Serviceware Initial Run	$1,500
Regulatory Permitting, Inspections & GA LLC Filing	**$550**
Total Approved Capital Outlay	**$106,550**

Contingency Reserve & Change Control Governance: The $5,000 contingency reserve is explicitly reserved for unforeseen mechanical outfitting, equipment fabrication variances, or municipal regulatory revisions. Project Manager authority is capped at $250 for minor operational adjustments. Any single change exceeding $250 or drawing from reserve funds requires explicit written sign-off from Project Owner Jalen Carter.

CORE PROJECT RISK MANAGEMENT REGISTER

Risk Event Description	Likelihood / Impact	Risk Trigger Condition	Planned Mitigation & Response Strategy
Permitting / Inspection Delays	**Med / High**	GDPH / City plan review extends past 3 weeks without response.	Submit architectural floor plans and commissary agreement 45 days early; pre-schedule inspections.
Truck Customization Cost Overruns	**Med / High**	Contractor labor hours or custom metal fabrication exceeds estimate.	Execute binding fixed-scope quotes before work starts; protect $5k contingency reserve strictly for mechanicals.
Equipment Failure in Testing	**Low / High**	Refrigeration or power fails during the 48-hr continuous stress run.	Source commercial-grade units backed by express replacement warranties; conduct full trial in Month 2.
Ingredient Cost Volatility	**Med / Med**	Direct food prices spike >8% across two consecutive wholesale orders.	Lock commercial wholesale accounts (Restaurant Depot); leverage high-margin core items (avg. 73.2% margin).
Lower-Than-Expected Foot Traffic	**Med / High**	Daily revenue dips below $450/day vs. $600/day baseline target.	Pivot two service days/week from static streets to pre-booked catering/events; reduce shift labor by 15%.

Academic Citation: Heagney, J. (2016). *Fundamentals of Project Management* (5th ed.). McGraw-Hill.

Project Dataset: Taylor, T. (2026). *The Treat Truck Financial Model & WBS Ledger*.